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The new system, if implemented, would increase the number of customers.

•

By roasting its own coffee, the shop has managed to reduce the difficulties (and cost) of maintaining an inventory of freshly roasted coffee.

•

Many customers stay in the cafe for long stretches of time.

•

The shop makes a substantial profit from pastries and other food bought by the coffee drinkers.

•

No other coffee shop in the area has such a system.

•

Birds have been said to be descended from certain birdlike dinosaur species with which they share distinctive structural features. The fossil record, however, shows that this cannot be so, since there are bird fossils that are much older than the earliest birdlike dinosaur fossils that have been found.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument relies?

A. The birdlike dinosaurs have no living descendants.

B. There are no flightless dinosaur species that have the distinctive structural features shared by birds and birdlike dinosaurs.

C. There are no birdlike dinosaur fossils that are older than the bird fossils but have not yet been unearthed.

D. It could not have been the case that some birds were descended from one of the birdlike dinosaur species and other birds from another.

E. Birds cannot have been descended from dinosaur species with which the birds do not share the distinctive structural features.

•

The total market value of real estate in Altonville has steadily declined over the past four years. This decline has meant the overall figure on which the city's property tax is based—the assessed value of that real estate—has also declined. Moreover, the percentage of assessed value that was paid as property taxes to the city did not change during this period.

The information above most strongly supports which of the following?

A. Money collected from property taxes provided most of Altonville's revenue during the past four years.

B. The percentage of Altonville's overall revenue that was collected from property taxes did not change over the past four years.

C. Altonville officials had proposed raising property tax rates during the past four years but never did so because of strong opposition from property owners.

D. The total amount of revenue that Altonville has collected from property taxes has declined over the past four years.

E. During the past four years, Altonville officials also did not increase tax rates on other sources of revenue such as retail sales or business profits.

•

Certain groups of Asian snails include both "left-handed" and "right-handed" species, with shells coiling to the left and right, respectively. Some left-handed species have evolved from right-handed ones. Also, researchers found that snail-eating snakes in the same habitat have asymmetrical jaws, allowing them to grasp right-handed snail shells more easily. If these snakes ate more right-handed snails over time, this would have given left-handed snails an evolutionary advantage over right-handed snails, with the left-handed snails eventually becoming a new species. Thus, the snakes' asymmetrical jaws probably helped drive the emergence of the left-handed snail species.

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Which of the following would, if true, most strengthen the argument that asymmetrical snake jaws helped drive left-handed snail evolution?

A. In one snake species, the snakes with asymmetrical jaws eat snails, while the snakes with symmetrical jaws do not eat snails.

B. Some species of Asian snails contain either all right-handed snails or all left-handed snails.

C. Anatomical differences prevent left-handed snails from mating easily with right-handed snails.

D. Some right-handed snails in this habitat have shells with a very narrow opening that helps prevent snakes from extracting the snails from inside their shells.

E. Experiments show that the snail-eating snakes in this habitat fail more often in trying to eat left-handed snails than in trying to eat right-handed snails.

•

A moderately large city is redesigning its central downtown area and is considering a plan that would reduce the number of lanes for automobiles and trucks and increase those for bicycles and pedestrians. The intent is to attract more workers and shoppers to downtown businesses by making downtown easier to reach and more pleasant to move around in.

Which of the following would, if true, most strongly support the prediction that the plan would achieve its goal?

A. People who make a habit of walking or bicycling whenever feasible derive significant health benefits from doing so.

B. Most people who prefer to shop at suburban malls instead of downtown urban areas do so because parking is easier and cheaper at the former.

C. In other moderately sized cities where measures were taken to make downtowns more accessible for walkers and cyclists, downtown businesses began to thrive.

D. If the proposed lane restrictions on drivers are rigorously enforced, more people will likely be attracted to downtown businesses than would otherwise be.

E. Most people who own and frequently ride bicycles for recreational purposes live at a significant distance from downtown urban areas.

•

Previously, Autoco designed all of its cars itself and then contracted with specialized parts suppliers to build parts according to its specifications. Now it plans to include its suppliers in designing the parts they are to build. Since many parts suppliers have more designers with specialized experience than Autoco has, Autoco expects this shift to reduce the overall time and cost of the design of its next new car.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports Autoco's expectation?

A. When suppliers provide their own designs, Autoco often needs to modify its overall design.

B. In order to provide designs for Autoco, several of the parts suppliers will have to add to their existing staffs of designers.

C. Parts and services provided by outside suppliers account for more than 50 percent of Autoco's total costs.

D. When suppliers built parts according to specifications provided by Autoco, the suppliers competed to win contracts.

E. Most of Autoco's suppliers have on hand a wide range of previously prepared parts designs that can readily be modified for a new car.

•

In response to viral infection, the immune systems of mice typically produce antibodies that destroy the virus by binding to proteins on its surface. Mice infected with the herpesvirus generally develop keratitis, a degenerative disease affecting part of the eye. Since proteins on the surface of cells in this part of the eye closely resemble those on the herpesvirus surface, scientists hypothesize that these cases of keratitis are caused by antibodies to the herpesvirus.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to support the scientists' reasoning?

A. Other types of viruses have surface proteins that closely resemble proteins found in various organs of mice.

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A. Other types of viruses have surface proteins that closely resemble proteins found in various organs of mice.

B. Mice that are infected with the herpesvirus but do not develop keratitis produce as many antibodies as infected mice that do develop keratitis.

C. Mice infected with a new strain of the herpesvirus that has different surface proteins did not develop keratitis.

D. Mice that have never been infected with the herpesvirus can sometimes develop keratitis.

E. There are mice that are unable to form antibodies in response to herpes infections, and these mice contract herpes at roughly the same rate as other mice.

•

One might expect that within a particular species, any individuals that managed to slow down the aging process would leave more offspring. Natural selection should therefore favor extreme longevity—but this does not seem to be the case. A possible explanation is that aging is a product of the inevitable wear and tear of living, similar to how household appliances generally accumulate faults that lead to their eventual demise. However, most researchers do not find this analogy satisfactory as an explanation.

Which of the following would, if true, provide the strongest explanation for the researchers' reaction?

A. Some organisms are capable of living much longer than other organisms.

B. Some organisms reproduce very quickly despite having short lifespans.

C. There are several ways of defining "extreme longevity," and according to some definitions it occurs frequently.

D. Organisms are capable of maintenance and self-repair and can remedy much of the damage that they accumulate.

E. Some organisms generate much more wear and tear on their bodies than others.

•

Last year a record number of new manufacturing jobs were created. Will this year bring another record? Well, **any new manufacturing job is created either within an existing company or by the start-up of a new company.** Within existing firms, new jobs have been created this year at well below last year's record pace. At the same time, there is considerable evidence that the number of new companies starting up this year will be no higher than it was last year, and **there is no reason to think that the new companies starting up this year will create more jobs per company than did last year's start-ups.** So clearly, the number of new jobs created this year will fall short of last year's record.

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first provides evidence in support of the main conclusion of the argument; the second is a claim that the argument challenges.

B. The first is a generalization that the argument seeks to establish; the second is a conclusion that the argument draws in order to support that generalization.

C. The first is a generalization that the argument seeks to establish; the second is a judgment that has been advanced in order to challenge that generalization.

D. The first is presented as an obvious truth on which the argument is based; the second is a claim that has been advanced in support of a position that the argument opposes.

E. The first is presented as an obvious truth on which the argument is based; the second is a judgment advanced in support of the main conclusion of the argument.

•

Last year a record number of new manufacturing jobs were created. Will this year bring another record? Well, **any new manufacturing job is created either within an existing company or by the start-up of a new company.** Within existing firms, new jobs have been created this year at well below last year's record pace. At the same time, there is considerable evidence that the number of new companies starting up will be no higher this year than it was last year, and there is no reason to think that the new companies starting up this year will create more jobs per company than did last year's start-ups. So clearly, **the number of new jobs created this year will fall short of last year's record.**

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is presented as an obvious truth on which the argument is based; the second is the main conclusion of

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A. The first is presented as an obvious truth on which the argument is based; the second is the main conclusion of the argument.

B. The first is presented as an obvious truth on which the argument is based; the second is a conclusion drawn in order to support the main conclusion of the argument.

C. The first and the second each provide evidence in support of the main conclusion of the argument.

D. The first is a generalization that the argument seeks to establish; the second is the main conclusion of the argument.

E. The first is a generalization that the argument seeks to establish; the second is a conclusion that has been drawn in order to challenge that generalization.

•

In Stenland, many workers have been complaining that they cannot survive on minimum wage, the lowest wage an employer is permitted to pay. The government is proposing to raise the minimum wage. Many employers who pay their workers the current minimum wage argue that if it is raised, unemployment will increase because they will no longer be able to afford to employ as many workers.

Which of the following, if true in Stenland, most strongly supports the claim that raising the minimum wage there will not have the effects that the employers predict?

A. For any position with wages below a living wage, the difficulty of finding and retaining employees adds as much to employment costs as would raising wages.

B. Raising the minimum wage does not also increase the amount employers have to contribute in employee benefits.

C. When inflation is taken into account, the proposed new minimum wage is not as high as the current one was when it was introduced.

D. Many employees currently being paid wages at the level of the proposed new minimum wage will demand significant wage increases.

E. Many employers who pay some workers only the minimum wage also pay other workers wages that are much higher than the minimum.

•

Biologists with a predilection for theory have tried—and largely failed—to define what it is that makes something a living thing. Organisms take in energy-providing materials and excrete waste products, but so do automobiles. Living things replicate and take part in evolution, but so do some computer programs. We must be open to the possibility that there are living things on other planets. Therefore, we will not be successful in defining what it is that makes something a living thing merely by examining living things on Earth—the only ones we know. Trying to do so is analogous to trying to specify _____.

Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

A. the laws of physics by using pure mathematics

B. what a fish is by listing its chemical components

C. what an animal is by examining a plant

D. what a machine is by examining a sketch of it

E. what a mammal is by examining a zebra

•

For the period from the eighth century through the eleventh century, the shifting boundaries between Kingdom F and Kingdom G have not been well charted. Although a certain village in a border region between the two kingdoms usually belonged to Kingdom G, ninth-century artifacts found in the village were in the typical Kingdom F style of that time. It is unclear whether the village was actually a part of Kingdom F in the ninth century or whether it was a part of Kingdom G but had merely adopted Kingdom F's artistic styles under Kingdom F's cultural influence.

Which of the following would, if found in ninth-century sites in the village, best help in determining whether the village was a part of Kingdom F or Kingdom G in the ninth century?

A. A trading contract written in the Kingdom G dialect

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B. A drawing of a dwelling complex known to have existed on the border of Kingdom F and Kingdom G in the ninth century

C. Knives and other utensils made from metal typical of ninth-century mining sites in Kingdom F

D. Some fragments of pottery made in the Kingdom G style from the seventh century out of materials only found in Kingdom F

E. Numerous teeth from the ninth century with a chemical signature typical only of teeth from people who had grown up in the heart of Kingdom F

•

Sammy: For my arthritis, I am going to try my aunt's diet: large amounts of wheat germ and garlic. She was able to move more easily right after she started that diet.

Pat: When my brother began that diet, his arthritis got worse. But he has been doing much better since he stopped eating vegetables in the nightshade family, such as tomatoes and peppers.

Which of the following, if true, would provide a basis for explaining the fact that Sammy's aunt and Pat's brother had contrasting experiences with the same diet?

A. A change in diet, regardless of the nature of the change, frequently brings temporary relief from arthritis symptoms.

B. The compounds in garlic that can lessen the symptoms of arthritis are also present in tomatoes and peppers.

C. Arthritis is a chronic condition whose symptoms improve and worsen from time to time without regard to diet.

D. In general, men are more likely to have their arthritis symptoms alleviated by avoiding vegetables in the nightshade family than are women.

E. People who are closely related are more likely to experience the same result from adopting a particular diet than are people who are unrelated.

•

In the 1960s, surveys of Florida's alligator population indicated that the population was dwindling rapidly. Hunting alligators was banned. By the early 1990s, the alligator population had recovered, and restricted hunting was allowed. Over the course of the 1990s, reports of alligators appearing on golf courses and lawns increased dramatically. Therefore, in spite of whatever alligator hunting went on, the alligator population must have increased significantly over the decade of the 1990s.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. The human population of Florida increased significantly during the 1990s.

B. The hunting restrictions applied to commercial as well as private hunters.

C. The number of sightings of alligators in lakes and swamps increased greatly in Florida during the 1990s.

D. Throughout the 1990s, selling alligator products was more strictly regulated than hunting was.

E. Most of the sightings of alligators on golf courses and lawns in the 1990s occurred at times at which few people were present on those golf courses and lawns.

•

Infotek, a computer manufacturer in Katrovia, has just introduced a new personal computer model that sells for significantly less than any other model. Market research shows, however, that very few Katrovian households without personal computers would buy a computer, regardless of its price. Therefore, introducing the new model is unlikely to increase the number of computers in Katrovian homes.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. Infotek achieved the lower price of the new model by using components of lower quality than those used by other manufacturers.

B. The main reason cited by consumers in Katrovia for replacing a personal computer is the desire to have an improved model.

C. Katrovians in households that already have computers are unlikely to purchase the new Infotek model as an additional computer for home use.

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additional computer for home use.

D. The price of other personal computers in Katrovia is unlikely to drop below the price of Infotek's new model in the near future.

E. Most personal computers purchased in Katrovia are intended for home use.

•

Fast-food restaurants make up 45 percent of all restaurants in Canatria. Customers at these restaurants tend to be young; in fact, studies have shown that the older people get, the less likely they are to eat in fast-food restaurants. Since the average age of the Canatrian population is gradually rising and will continue to do so, the number of fast-food restaurants is likely to decrease.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. Fast-food restaurants in Canatria are getting bigger, so each one can serve more customers.

B. Some older people eat at fast-food restaurants more frequently than the average young person.

C. Many people who rarely eat in fast-food restaurants nevertheless eat regularly in restaurants.

D. The overall population of Canatria is growing steadily.

E. As the population of Canatria gets older, more people are eating at home.

•

Last year a chain of fast-food restaurants, whose menu had always centered on hamburgers, added its first vegetarian sandwich, much lower in fat than the chain's other offerings. Despite heavy marketing, the new sandwich accounts for a very small proportion of the chain's sales. The sandwich's sales would have to quadruple to cover the costs associated with including it on the menu. Since such an increase is unlikely, the chain would be more profitable if it dropped the sandwich.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. Although many of the chain's customers have never tried the vegetarian sandwich, in a market research survey, most of those who had tried it reported that they were very satisfied with it.

B. Many of the people who eat at the chain's restaurants also eat at the restaurants of competing chains and report no strong preference among the competitors.

C. Among fast-food chains in general, there has been little or no growth in hamburger sales over the past several years as the range of competing offerings at other restaurants has grown.

D. When even one member of a group of diners is a vegetarian or has a preference for low-fat food, the group tends to avoid restaurants that lack vegetarian or low-fat menu options.

E. An attempt by the chain to introduce a lower-fat hamburger failed several years ago, since it attracted few new customers and most of the chain's regular customers greatly preferred the taste of the regular hamburgers.

•

Transportation expenses accounted for a large portion of the total dollar amount spent on trips for pleasure by residents of the United States in 1997, and about half of the total dollar amount spent on transportation was for airfare. However, the large majority of United States residents who took trips for pleasure in 1997 did not travel by airplane but used other means of transportation.

If the statements above are true, which of the following must also be true about United States residents who took trips for pleasure in 1997?

A. Most of those who traveled by airplane did so because the airfare to their destination was lower than the cost of other available means of transportation.

B. Most of those who traveled by airplane did so because other means of transportation to their destination were unavailable.

C. Per mile traveled, those who traveled by airplane tended to spend more on transportation to their destination than did those who used other means of transportation.

D. Overall, people who did not travel by airplane had lower average transportation expenses than people who did.

E. Those who traveled by airplane spent about as much, on average, on other means of transportation as they did on

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E. Those who traveled by airplane spent about as much, on average, on other means of transportation as they did on airfare.

•

Voters commonly condemn politicians for being insincere, but politicians often must disguise their true feelings when they make public statements. If they expressed their honest views—about, say, their party's policies—then achieving politically necessary compromises would be much more difficult. Clearly, the very insincerity that people decry shows that our government is functioning well.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines this reasoning?

A. Achieving political compromises is not all that is necessary for the proper functioning of a government.

B. Some political compromises are not in the best long-term interest of the government.

C. Voters often judge politicians by criteria other than the sincerity with which they express their views.

D. A political party's policies could turn out to be detrimental to the functioning of a government.

E. Some of the public statements made by politicians about their party's policies could in fact be sincere.

•

One summer, floods covered low-lying garlic fields situated in a region with a large mosquito population. Since mosquitoes lay their eggs in standing water, flooded fields would normally attract mosquitoes, yet no mosquitoes were found in the fields. Diallyl sulfide, a major component of garlic, is known to repel several species of insects, including mosquitoes, so it is likely that diallyl sulfide from the garlic repelled the mosquitoes.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

A. Diallyl sulfide is also found in onions but at concentrations lower than in garlic.

B. The mosquito population of the region as a whole was significantly smaller during the year in which the flooding took place than it had been in previous years.

C. By the end of the summer, most of the garlic plants in the flooded fields had been killed by waterborne fungi.

D. Many insect species not repelled by diallyl sulfide were found in the flooded garlic fields throughout the summer.

E. Mosquitoes are known to be susceptible to toxins in plants other than garlic, such as marigolds.

•

The population of desert tortoises in Targland's Red Desert has declined, partly because they are captured for sale as pets and partly because people riding all-terrain vehicles have damaged their habitat. Targland plans to halt this population decline by blocking the current access routes into the desert and announcing new regulations to allow access only on foot. Targland's officials predict that these measures will be adequate, since it is difficult to collect the tortoises without a vehicle.

Which of the following would it be most important to establish in order to evaluate the officials' prediction?

A. Whether possessing the tortoises as pets remains legally permissible in Targland

B. Whether Targland is able to enforce the regulations with respect to all-terrain vehicle entry at points other than the current access routes

C. Whether the Red Desert tortoises are most active during the day or at night

D. Whether people who travel on foot in the Red Desert often encounter the tortoises

E. Whether the Targland authorities held public hearings before restricting entry by vehicle into the Red Desert

•

Yeasts capable of leavening bread are widespread, and in the many centuries during which the ancient Egyptians made only unleavened bread, such yeasts must frequently have been mixed into bread doughs accidentally. The Egyptians, however, did not discover leavened bread until about 3000 B.C. That discovery roughly coincided with the introduction of a wheat variety that was preferable to previous varieties because its edible kernel could be removed from the husk without first toasting the grain.

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest evidence that the two developments were causally related?

A. Even after the ancient Egyptians discovered leavened bread and the techniques for reliably producing it were

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A. Even after the ancient Egyptians discovered leavened bread and the techniques for reliably producing it were well known, unleavened bread continued to be widely consumed.

B. Only when the Egyptians stopped the practice of toasting grain were their stone-lined grain-toasting pits available for baking bread.

C. Heating a wheat kernel destroys its gluten, a protein that must be present in order for yeast to leaven bread dough.

D. The new variety of wheat, which had a more delicate flavor because it was not toasted, was reserved for the consumption of high officials when it first began to be grown.

E. Because the husk of the new variety of wheat was more easily removed, flour made from it required less effort to produce.

•

In parts of the Caribbean, the manatee, an endangered marine mammal, has long been hunted for food. Having noted the manatee hunters' expert knowledge of manatees' habits, local conservationists are encouraging the hunters to stop hunting and instead to take tourists on boat rides to see manatees. Many tourists are interested, so the plan has promise of achieving the twin goals of giving the former hunters a good income and helping ensure the manatees' survival.

Which of the following, if true, raises the most serious doubt about the plan's chance of success?

A. Some tourists who visit these parts of the Caribbean are uninterested in manatees and would not take a boat ride to see them.

B. Recovery of the species would enable some hunting to continue without putting the manatees' survival in jeopardy again.

C. In areas where manatees have traditionally been hunted for food, local people could easily replace the manatee meat in their diets with other foods obtained from the sea.

D. There would not be enough former manatee hunters to act as guides for all the tourists who want to see manatees.

E. To maintain a good income guiding tourists, manatee hunters would have to use far larger boats and make many more trips into the manatees' fragile habitat than they currently do.

•

That the application of new technology can increase the productivity of existing coal mines is demonstrated by the case of Tribnia's coal industry. Coal output per miner in Tribnia is double what it was five years ago even though no new mines have opened.

Which of the following can be properly concluded from the statement about coal output per miner in the passage?

A. If the number of miners working in Tribnian coal mines has remained constant in the past five years, Tribnia's total coal production has doubled in that period of time.

B. Any individual Tribnian coal mine that achieved an increase in overall output in the past five years has also experienced an increase in output per miner.

C. If any new coal mines had opened in Tribnia in the past five years, then the increase in output per miner would have been even greater than it actually was.

D. If any individual Tribnian coal mine has not increased its output per miner in the past five years, then that mine's overall output has declined or remained constant.

E. In Tribnia, the cost of producing a given quantity of coal has declined over the past five years.

•

The quality of an unrefined olive oil is not actually defined in terms of acidity, yet extensive tests have shown that the less free oleic acid an unrefined olive oil contains per liter, the higher its quality. The proportion of free oleic acid that an olive oil contains is an accurate measure of the oil's acidity.

If the statements above are all true, which of the following conclusions is best supported by them?

A. When an olive oil is refined, the concentration of oleic acid in the oil is reduced.

B. The quality of an unrefined olive oil can be determined only by accurately measuring its acidity.

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B. The quality of an unrefined olive oil can be determined only by accurately measuring its acidity.

C. If an unrefined olive oil is intermediate in acidity between two other unrefined olive oils, it will also be intermediate between them in quality.

D. Free oleic acid is the only acid that unrefined olive oil contains.

E. People who judge the quality of unrefined olive oils actually judge those oils by their acidity, which the judges can taste.

•

Shipping clerk: The five specially ordered shipments sent out last week were sent out on Thursday. Last week, all of the shipments sent out on Friday consisted entirely of building supplies, and the shipping department then closed for the weekend. Four shipments were sent to Truax Construction last week, only three of which consisted of building supplies.

If the shipping clerk's statements are true, which of the following must also be true?

A. At least one of the shipments sent to Truax Construction last week was specially ordered.

B. At least one of last week's specially ordered shipments did not consist of building supplies.

C. At least one of the shipments sent to Truax Construction was not sent out on Thursday of last week.

D. At least one of the shipments sent out on Friday of last week was sent to Truax Construction.

E. At least one of the shipments sent to Truax Construction last week was sent out before Friday.

•

In Kravonia, the average salary for jobs requiring a college degree has always been higher than the average salary for jobs that do not require a degree. Current enrollments in Kravonia's colleges indicate that over the next four years, the percentage of the Kravonian workforce with college degrees will increase dramatically. Therefore, the average salary for all workers in Kravonia is likely to increase over the next four years.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. Kravonians with more than one college degree earn more, on average, than do Kravonians with only one college degree.

B. The percentage of Kravonians who attend college in order to earn higher salaries is higher now than it was several years ago.

C. The higher average salary for jobs requiring a college degree is not due largely to a scarcity among the Kravonian workforce of people with a college degree.

D. The average salary in Kravonia for jobs that do not require a college degree will not increase over the next four years.

E. Few members of the Kravonian workforce earned their degrees in other countries.

•

Charcoal from a hearth site in Colorado, 2,000 miles south of Alaska, is known to be 11,200 years old. Siberia is located in northeast Russia, and Alaska is located in northwest America. Researchers reasoned since glaciers prevented human migration south from the Alaska-Siberia land bridge between 18,000 and 11,000 years ago, humans must have come to the Americas more than 18,000 years ago.

Which of the following pieces of new evidence would cast doubt on the conclusion drawn above?

A. Using new radiocarbon dating techniques, it was determined the charcoal from the Colorado site was at least 11,400 years old.

B. Another campsite was found in New Mexico with remains dated at 16,000 years old.

C. A computer simulation of glacial activity showed it would already have been impossible for humans to travel south overland from Alaska 18,500 years ago.

D. Using new radiocarbon dating techniques, it was proven that an ice-free corridor allowed passage south from the Alaska-Siberia land bridge approximately 11,400 years ago.

E. Studies of various other hunting-gathering populations showed convincingly that once the glaciers allowed passage, humans could have migrated from Alaska to Colorado in about 20 years.

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•

A group of children of various ages was read stories in which people caused harm, with some of those people doing so intentionally and some accidentally. When asked about appropriate punishments for those who had caused harm, the younger children, unlike the older ones, assigned punishments that did not vary according to whether the harm was done intentionally or accidentally. Younger children, then, do not regard people's intentions as relevant to punishment.

Which of the following, if true, would most seriously weaken the conclusion above?

A. In interpreting these stories, the listeners had to draw on a relatively mature sense of human psychology in order to tell whether harm was produced intentionally or accidentally.

B. In these stories, the severity of the harm produced was clearly stated.

C. Younger children are as likely to produce harm unintentionally as older children.

D. The older children assigned punishment in a way that closely resembled the way adults had assigned punishment in a similar experiment.

E. The younger children assigned punishments that varied according to the severity of the harm done by the agents in the stories.

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Mansour: We should both plan to change some of our investments from coal companies to less polluting energy companies, and here's why: Consumers are increasingly demanding nonpolluting energy, and energy companies are increasingly supplying it.

Therese: I'm not sure we should do what you suggest. As demand for nonpolluting energy increases relative to supply, its price will increase, and then the more polluting energy will cost relatively less. Demand for the cheaper, dirtier energy forms will then increase, as will the stock values of the companies that produce them.

Therese responds to Mansour's proposal by doing which of the following?

A. Advocating that consumers use less expensive forms of energy

B. Implying that not all uses of coal for energy are necessarily polluting

C. Disagreeing with Mansour's claim that consumers are increasingly demanding nonpolluting energy

D. Suggesting that leaving their existing energy investments unchanged could be the better course

E. Providing a reason to doubt Mansour's assumption that supply of nonpolluting energy will increase in line with demand

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The earliest Mayan pottery found at Colha in Belize is about 3,000 years old. Recently, however, 4,500-year-old stone agricultural implements were unearthed at Colha. These implements resemble Mayan stone implements of a much later period, also found at Colha. Moreover, the implements' designs are strikingly different from the designs of stone implements produced by other cultures known to have inhabited the area in prehistoric times. Therefore, there were surely Mayan settlements in Colha 4,500 years ago.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. Ceramic ware is not known to have been used by the Mayans to make agricultural implements.

B. Carbon dating of corn pollen in Colha indicates agriculture began there around 4,500 years ago.

C. Archaeological evidence indicates some of the oldest stone implements found at Colha were used to cut away vegetation after controlled burning of trees to open areas of swampland for cultivation.

D. Successor cultures at a given site often adopt the style of agricultural implements used by earlier inhabitants of the same site.

E. Many religious and social institutions of the Mayan people who inhabited Colha 3,000 years ago relied on a highly developed system of agricultural symbols.

Questions 739–802 — Difficulty: Hard

739. Duckbill dinosaurs, like today's monitor lizards, had particularly long tails, which they could whip at considerable speed. Monitor lizards use their tails to strike predators. However, although duckbill tails were

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considerable speed. Monitor lizards use their tails to strike predators. However, although duckbill tails were otherwise very similar to those of monitor lizards, the duckbill's tailbones were proportionately much thinner and thus more delicate. Moreover, to ward off their proportionately much larger predators, duckbills would have had to whip their tails considerably faster than monitor lizards do.

The information given, if accurate, provides the strongest support for which of the following hypotheses?

A. If duckbills whipped their tails faster than monitor lizards do, the duckbill's tail would have been effective at warding off the duckbills' fiercest predators.

B. Duckbills used their tails to strike predators, and their tailbones were frequently damaged from the impact.

C. Using their tails was not the only means duckbills had for warding off predators.

D. Duckbills were at much greater risk of being killed by a predator than monitor lizards are.

E. The tails of duckbills, if used to ward off predators, would have been more likely than the tails of monitor lizards to sustain damage from the impact.

740. In an attempt to produce a coffee plant that would yield beans containing no caffeine, the synthesis of a substance known to be integral to the initial stages of caffeine production was blocked either in the beans, in the leaves, or both. For those plants in which synthesis of the substance was blocked only in the leaves, the resulting beans contained no caffeine.

Any of the following, if true, would provide the basis for an explanation of the observed results EXCEPT:

A. In coffee plants, the substance is synthesized only in the leaves and then moves to the beans, where the initial stages of caffeine production take place.

B. In coffee plants, the last stage of caffeine production takes place in the beans using a compound that is produced only in the leaves by the substance.

C. In coffee plants, the initial stages of caffeine production take place only in the beans, but later stages depend on another substance that is synthesized only in the leaves and does not depend on the blocked substance.

D. In coffee plants, caffeine production takes place only in the leaves, but the caffeine then moves to the beans.

E. Caffeine was produced in the beans of the modified coffee plants, but all of it moved to the leaves, which normally produce their own caffeine.

741. Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

Laminated glass is much harder to break than the glass typically used in the windows of cars driven in Relnia. It is more difficult for thieves to break into cars with laminated glass windows than into cars with ordinary glass windows, and laminated glass windows are less likely to break in a collision. Nevertheless, considerations of security and safety do not unambiguously support a proposal to require that in Relnia all glass installed in cars be laminated glass, since _____.

A. most people cannot visually distinguish laminated glass from the glass typically used for car windows

B. a significant proportion of cars driven in Relnia are manufactured elsewhere

C. some cars in Relnia already have laminated glass in their windows

D. the rates of car theft and of collisions have both fallen slightly in Relnia in recent years

E. there are times when breaking a car's window is the best way to provide timely help for people trapped inside

742.

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